Application: 8431786432

Charles Njoku - hello@charlesnjoku.com
Tech Nation Visa Application

Summary

ID: 8431786432

Application Form

Completed - 25 Apr 2022

For instructions regarding application requirements, please see the **Tech Nation Visa Guide**.

Application Form

OFFICIAL DETAILS

Are you applying for yourself or acting on behalf of an applicant?

Applying for myself

Are you applying directly for Global Talent or Switching from another visa category?

Applying directly for Global Talent

Please provide your Unique Application Number (UAN) from your completed Stage 1 endorsement application on the Gov.uk website:

This is required so that Tech Nation can match your application to your Home Office application. The UAN is usually available in the email sent to you by the Home Office or within the 'Document Checklist' attachment. This number must begin with 1212 and have 16 numbers and 3 dashes, for example: 1212-0001-0001-0001

Important: failure to provide this number correctly may lead to delays in processing your application!

1212-0001-1630-9741

What was the confirmed submission date of your Stage 1 endorsement application on the Gov.uk website:

This must be the official date of submission confirmed by the Home Office. It is important to enter the correct date, as this information may be used by the system to determine various settings, such as application questions or criteria.

21 Apr 2022

PERSONAL DETAILS

Full Name

Charles Onuabuchi Njoku

Date of Birth

9 Aug 1997

Passport Number

A10827586

Gender

Male

Nationality

Nigeria

Country of residence

Nigeria

City of residence (or nearest)

Lagos

Intended UK country of residence

England

Intended region of residence in England

West Midlands

Intended UK city of residence (or nearest)

Birmingham

Current Residence address

Lagoon View Estate, Makoko Road, Yaba Lagos

Current Residence postcode

410001

Is your Correspondence address the same as your Current Residence address?

Yes

Is your Intended Residence Address in the UK the same as your Current Residence address above?

No

Intended residence address in UK

150 Moseley Street, Birmingham

Intended UK residence postcode

B12 0RU

Contact telephone number

+2348147928631

Email Address

hello@charlesnjoku.com

LinkedIn profile

optional

https://www.linkedin.com/in/madebycharles

USEFUL INFORMATION

How did you hear about Tech Nation Visa

Tech Nation Visa Alumni

How long ago did you first hear about Tech Nation Visa?

More than 12 months

How long ago did you decide to apply for Tech Nation Visa?

3 - 6 months

Please tell us if you would like to receive emails from Tech Nation regarding visa related marketing and/or events (including partner events)?

Note: This confirmation is effective immediately and applies to both open and submitted applications.

Responses Selected:

I agree to receiving marketing.

Tech Nation operates an Alumni Network for those who are successfully awarded the Global Talent visa. Would you like to receive emails from Tech Nation regarding the Alumni Network, including how to join and related events?

Responses Selected:

I agree to receive emails regarding the Alumni Network

FAST TRACK OPTIONS

Do you wish your application to be considered for the Fast Track option?

Please note that Fast track only impacts Tech Nation's processing times, it does not impact eligibilty. Tech Nation is unable to inform you whether your application is being processed under Fast Track. Please see the Fast Track section on the official Global Talent website for more information.

No

CAREER SUMMARY

How long has your career been in the digital technology sector?

More than 5 years in digital technology

SECTOR / SKILLS

Please indicate your sector

Apps & Software Development

Please indicate your specialist skill

UX designer

EDUCATION

Highest formal education level completed

Bachelors degree

Name of university or institution

Please write the name of the institution as it appears on your certificate / official documents.

University of Nigeria Nsukka

Location of university or institution

Enugu, Nigeria

Highest professional qualification (if any)

(No response)

EMPLOYMENT

Are you currently employed? (either as an employee or as a founder/director)

Yes

Present workplace/employer

Please only write the name of organisation.

Spire Technologies, Inc

Present position/role

Co-founder & CEO

Type of present position/role

Founder

Start date of present employment

3 May 2021

Address of present employer

651 North Broad Street, Middletown Delaware, United States

Company registration number of present employer

37-2001128

Website of present employer

https://www.getspire.io

OFFER OF EMPLOYMENT IN UK

Have you been offered a job in the UK?

No

Are you actively looking for a job in the UK?

Yes

BUSINESS DETAILS

Do you have any active digital technology business(es) that you have established?

Yes

Are the business(es) registered in the UK?

No

Where are the business(es) registered?

United States

Company registration number

37-2001128

Website of active business(es)

https://www.getspire.io

Please provide details of the active digital technology business(es) you have established:

Spire Technologies, Inc. is a Customer Experience Management software company building products and tools to help internet and local businesses collect customer feedback, conduct customer research and test products all in one platform.

With Spire, businesses are able to learn more about their customers, aggregate feedback and collaborate across teams to uncover insights that will help them improve their products and deliver better experiences for their customers.

I and my co-founder started Spire in March of 2021 and got incorporated in April of 2021. We are currently in private beta and have raised $100,000 from friends and family.

Do you have any dissolved digital technology business(es) that you have established?

No

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Are you applying under the eligibility criteria for Exceptional Talent or Exceptional Promise?

Please select carefully because you will be presented with the relevant eligibility criteria for Exceptional Talent or Exceptional Promise and your application will be assessed accordingly.

Exceptional Promise

What is the main reason you have chosen to apply for the route of 'Exceptional Promise' (rather than Exceptional Talent)?

While my overall experience in general spans over the last 7years, the majority of my digital technology experience with verifiable pieces of evidence happened within the last 4years. The 'Exceptional Promise' route seems adequate to highlight my contributions as having the potential to be a leading talent.

An applicant evidencing EXCEPTIONAL PROMISE must:

Responses Selected:

Show they have been recognised as having potential to be a leading talent in the digital technology sector in the last 5 years

Which criteria are you applying for? Please choose 2 of the following:

Responses Selected:

At least 1 example of proof of recognition for work beyond the applicant’s occupation that contributes to the advancement of the field

At least 1 example of significant technical, commercial or entrepreneurial contributions to the field as a founder or employee of a product-led digital technology company

EVIDENCE FILES

The information requested below relates to the ten evidence files that you will upload as part of your application.

Note: Whilst you can use multiple documents to support each criteria, each document must only contain a single piece of related evidence.

Please provide the names of documents submitted in support of your mandatory 'leading talent' criteria for Exceptional Promise:

Google Developer Group Recommendation by Aniedi Udo-Obong.pdf
Letter of Recommendation-Odulu Ann Amos.pdf
Proof of Commanding high Salary.pdf

Please provide the names of documents submitted in support of your first optional criteria for Exceptional Promise:

Open Source Contributions.pdf
Recognitions of Mentorship.pdf
Speaking Engagements.pdf

Please provide the names of documents submitted in support of your second optional criteria for Exceptional Promise:

Evidence of Technical Contributions.pdf
Product-led Startup - Spire.pdf
Reference Letter - Emmanuel Ezenwere.pdf

PERSONAL STATEMENT

Please explain why you believe you qualify for the Tech Nation Visa and how you satisfy the criteria for Exceptional Promise

Personal Statements must be submitted using this form, separate uploads are not acceptable.

I am a UX designer and technology entrepreneur with over 6years of experience designing, building and executing impactful digital products and innovative strategies across several industries in Africa.

As young as 14, I began my entrepreneurial journey co-managing my family's printing press business with my dad. By 16, I actively started building up my experience in other technology sectors by self-learning on Udacity and Coursera. In 2015 I joined Upwork as a freelancer and virtual assistant, working remotely with clients globally across several projects.

In 2018 I joined Arone to lead its product and experience design team; Arone is one of Africa's pioneer drone tech startups. In collaboration with its CEO, our work was responsible for an award by the National Information Technology Development Agency (NITDA) that included a sponsorship to GITEX2018 in Dubai. We also won the SLUSH Global Impact Accelerator Regional finals to represent Nigeria at the global finals in Helsinki. We became a national sensation and had the opportunity to meet with Nigeria's President and top Government officials in 2019 and eventually signed an MOU to collaborate with Nigeria's Ministry of Defense drone program in 2020.

My experience designing products and interfacing with the Government became instrumental when I joined Softcom in 2019 as a Creative Designer. At Softcom, I lead the design and illustration of a 'Resident Identity Management System' for the Ondo State Government of Nigeria and Nigeria's N-Power Project. I provided design, marketing, and communications support across the different teams and stakeholders, highlighting its impact on combating poverty with technology.

I joined Trium, a Venture Studio, in 2020 as a UX Designer. At Trium, I lead the design of several products, such as 'Access Nation' - a concept all-in-one marketplace for Africa's largest consumer bank and an Escrow-as-a-Service platform for SMEs in Nigeria. At the onset of COVID, SBSC, an enterprise software consulting firm, hired me to redesign its white-label Hospital Management System - eMed Diaries to account for new changes in health protocols.

My experiences have been very in-depth across different roles and aspects of technology innovation for Government and businesses. I have practical insight into what it takes to build for impact. The UK's

booming technology ecosystem and attractive investor activity are why I have chosen to move to the UK. I intend to continue establishing my expertise, build a global business and contribute my wealth of experience to growing its sector and the economy. I will be bringing my product-led technology startup, Spire, a customer experience management software for internet and local businesses.

According to The Institute of Customer Service (ICS), customer service complaints have reached a record high in the UK, with several customers complaining about service shortages, poor products or bad quality. Also, in 2021 alone, eCommerce sales in the UK were up to $169B, with 86% of customers making buying decisions from reviews, ratings and customer feedback. All of these present a massive opportunity for Spire; Spire will help UK businesses collect and manage feedback from their customers from anywhere- all in one place. With our products, businesses can build a solid reputation online through reviews, ratings and customer feedback and get found easily on the internet by customers who want the best. They will also be able to resolve and improve their customer experience issues faster, improve their products and ultimately grow their business.

We validated the idea and tested our MVP with 300+ users out of the 2,000+ who signed up to our waitlist. 17% of the 2,000+ who signed up to our waitlist are people/companies in the UK. But building a global business in Nigeria is challenging due to infrastructural, capital-related and other market constraints. Also, Nigeria's heavily funded fintech sector takes most of the PR, talent, and resources available in the ecosystem, making it more challenging to continue building a SaaS product like Spire in Nigeria. The UK's ecosystem has better market readiness, adoption, and successes in our chosen business segment, and it is evident in LSE-listed companies like TrustPilot and Yell as well as venture-backed startups like UserBack and Broadly. The UK is arguably the best environment to propel Spirē into what I believe it can become - a global business helping other businesses succeed anywhere.

Since 2018, at least two customer feedback software have been acquired by customer experience and big data giants like Qualtrics, Twilio, SurveyMonkey and Zendesk. I believe we will see this trend increase as more and more businesses serve global customers, and Spirē can take advantage of this trend to become incredibly successful.

While in the UK, I will join an accelerator, and also take up consulting/part-time jobs to support me until my startup is well funded to support me adequately. I will also contribute to community work outside of my day-to-day technology business. My experience as a volunteer and mentor in several capacities has given me practical experiences on how important it is to continue to contribute and build communities.

The UK has been one of my favourite places I dreamed of living, working and touring, in fact, I have been

a Chelsea Football fan since I was a kid. I will be settling in the city of Birmingham upon my arrival in the UK. Besides being one of the best cities to live in, Birmingham boasts of universities, young talents, and a growing startup ecosystem providing me with adequate resources, personnel, and environment to thrive. I think this is an excellent place for me to settle.

REFEREE DETAILS

Please provide details for your Letter of Recommendation referees

Full name of first referee

Dr. Didi Emokpare

Address of first referee

4246 ALBERT STREET, SUITE 180 REGINA SK S4S 3R9 CANADA

Email of first referee

didi.emokpare@outpost.health

Telephone number of first referee

+13065812626

LinkedIn URL of first referee (optional)

https://www.linkedin.com/in/didi-emokpare-ba805547/

Full name of second referee

Adedeji Olowe

Address of second referee

4 Rock Drive, Lekki Phase 1, Lagos, Nigeria.

Email of second referee

adedeji@lendsqr.com

Telephone number of second referee

+2347034138291

LinkedIn URL of second referee (optional)

https://www.linkedin.com/in/adedejiolowe/

Full name of third referee

Edmund Olotu

Address of third referee

Lagos, Nigeria

Email of third referee

edmund@blochq.io

Telephone number of third referee

+2348073828767

LinkedIn URL of third referee (optional)

https://www.linkedin.com/in/edmundolotu/

ADDITIONAL REFEREE DETAILS

If you are supplying additional letters of recommendation, in addition to the three mandatory references above, please provide the individual names of these references in the spaces provided below (please note that using references as part of your evidence is separate from your official three Letters of Recommendation)

Are you suppling additional references within your evidence, in addition to the mandatory three Letters of Recommendation?

Yes - I am supplying more references as part of my evidence

Full name of Additional Referee

Emmanuel Ezenwere

Full name of Additional Referee

Aniedi Udo-Obong

Full name of Additional Referee

Osemudiame Harry Enaholo

Full name of Additional Referee

Abiodun Fiwa Okunade

Full name of Additional Referee

Odulu Ikogi Amos

Full name of Additional Referee

(No response)

Full name of Additional Referee

(No response)

Full name of Additional Referee

(No response)

Full name of Additional Referee

(No response)

Full name of Additional Referee

(No response)

Upload CV

Completed - 22 Apr 2022

Charles Onuabuchi Njoku - Resume (2)

Filename: Charles_Onuabuchi_Njoku_-_Resume_2.pdf **Size:** 106.6 kB

Letter of Recommendation 1

Completed - 22 Apr 2022

Letter of Recommendation-Didi Emokpare

Filename: Letter_of_Recommendation-Didi_Emokpare.pdf **Size:** 372.5 kB

Letter of Recommendation 2

Completed - 24 Apr 2022

Letter of Recommendation - Adedeji Olowe

Filename: Letter_of_Recommendation_-_Adedeji_Olowe.pdf **Size:** 593.5 kB

Letter of Recommendation 3

Completed - 26 Apr 2022

Letter of Recommendation - Edmund Olotu

Filename: Letter_of_Recommendation_-_Edmund_Olotu.pdf **Size:** 2.2 MB

Evidence Files

Completed - 26 Apr 2022

Letter of Recommendation-Odulu Ann Amos

Filename: Letter_of_Recommendation-Odulu_Ann_Amos.pdf **Size:** 197.4 kB

Google Developer Group Recommendation by Aniedi Udo-Obong

Filename: Google_Developer_Group_Recommendat_nylfkwX.pdf **Size:** 90.9 kB

Proof of Commanding high Salary

Filename: Proof_of_Commanding_high_Salary.pdf **Size:** 773.0 kB

Open Source Contributions

Filename: Open_Source_Contributions.pdf **Size:** 1.3 MB

Speaking Engagements

Filename: Speaking_Engagements_STJ50pG.pdf **Size:** 370.7 kB

Recognition of Mentorship

Filename: Recognition_of_Mentorship.pdf **Size:** 1.5 MB

Evidence of Technical Contributions

Filename: Evidence_of_Technical_Contributions.pdf **Size:** 57.6 kB

Produt-led Startup - Spirē

Filename: Produt-led_Startup_-_Spire.pdf **Size:** 900.0 kB

Reference Letter - Emmanuel Ezenwere

Filename: Reference_Letter_-_Emmanuel_Ezenwere.pdf **Size:** 768.1 kB

Your Feedback

Completed - 22 Apr 2022

Form for "Your Feedback"

This is your opportunity to provide feedback regarding Tech Nation Visa so that we may improve the experience for future applicants. **It is entirely optional.**

This feedback will not be shared with our assessment panel and will not impact your assessment.

Thank you!

On a scale of zero to ten, how likely are you to recommend the Tech Nation Visa to a friend or colleague?

Zero is low and ten is high.

Rating	10

How would you rate the Home Office (Gov.uk) part of the process?

Zero is low and ten is high.

Rating	10

How would you rate the Tech Nation part of the process?

Zero is low and ten is high.

Rating	10

Please tell us about your experience and what you thought were the best and worst parts of the whole process?

The Tech Nation Guides as well as its forums were really helpful.

Charles Onuabuchi Njoku

Address: Lagos, Nigeria, **Phone:** (+234) 814 792 8631,

Email: hello@charlesnjoku.com | Linkedin | Website

Charles is one of Nigeria's promising technology entrepreneurs with experience across several technology fields over the past 5years. He has had experience working with tech businesses and startups as a Marketing and Communications specialist, Brand Identity Designer and Strategist, UX Designer, as well as a Product Lead.

Charles is very interested in society's biggest challenges; education, healthcare and wealth. He is always at the intersection of designing for these use cases, connecting people to the value of technology and elevating their experiences.

EDUCATION

Oct 2014 - August 2018 - **B.Sc Biochemistry** :: University of Nigeria, Nsukka

May 2019 - **Digital Transformation Certificate Course** :: University of Virginia Darden Business School via coursera.org

April 2020 - **Product Masterclass: How to Build Digital Products** :: Product School (productschool.com)

May 2020 - **UX Design Nanodegree** :: Udacity (udacity.com)

SKILLS

Product; Design and Research:

- UI/UX Design, UX & CX Research, Product Strategy, UX Audit/Analysis, Usability Testing etc.
- Brand Identity, and Visual Design, illustration, Interaction Design.
- Market Research and Strategy, Product UX Writing, Brand Awareness and Strategy, Digital Communications.

Software Stack

- Figma, InVision, Sketch and XD
- Miro, Zeplin, and UXTesting
- Webflow, Protopie and Framer
- HTML and CSS, JavaScript, WordPress

INTERESTS

- Digital Design and Technology, People, Food, Music, Politics, Entrepreneurship, Public Policy, and Management.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Spirē, Co-founder

April 2021 - Present

- At Spire, we are building products and tools that will help businesses use customer feedback to build better products and experiences for their customers.

Outpost Health,

DECEMBER 2021 - Present: Product Consultant

MARCH 2021 - NOVEMBER 2021: Remote — Product & Growth Lead

- Designed Product and GTM strategies for virtual healthcare products focused on capturing diaspora Nigerians who spend money on healthcare for their elderly relatives'
- Designed user testing framework and set metrics to measure success via customer journey interviews

Africa Leadership International, Remote — Platform *UX Designer*

JANUARY 2021 - SEPTEMBER 2021

- Lead the design of ALX's (www.alx.app) Young Leader Development Platform that will train and connect millions of young African leaders to the skills, and job opportunities.

Testimonial from VP Product - Seth Trudeau

> *Charles was a critical member of a small, scrappy team working on platform development for ALX. The 3 people on the team moved from concept to fully functional v1 in less than 2 months, and Charles was the driving force behind the UX & visual design. He was highly adaptable, especially as we did a major revamp of our branding right at the end of the design phase.*

Software Business Solutions Consulting, Lagos, Nigeria— *UX Designer*

AUGUST 2020 - JANUARY 2021

- Collaborated with a cross-functional Agile Team to deliver resource-intensive projects serving legacy organizations across organizations in Nigeria.
    - **Greenpole:** A proprietary enterprise registrar operating software developed for Africa Prudential. It is a web-enabled financial asset management software for financial institutions in Nigeria.
    - **eMed:** eMed is designed to automate the processes of healthcare delivery. It was designed specifically for hospitals that need low-cost IT solutions for their hospital management.

Trium Networks Limited, Lagos, Nigeria— *UX Designer*

FEBRUARY 2020 - MAY 2020

- Worked with product owners to interpret product vision and translate them into intuitive user journey maps and conduct UX research via customer interviews, observations and other methods for;
    - **Access Nation:** Social-commerce marketplace product that mimics Instagram's UX, enabling vendors to create stores easily and buyers visit stores like they would visit their IG feeds. Payments involved an escrow service and a core-banking process for both buyers and sellers.
    - **Stormgarden:** A stock trading platform to enable users to trade digitally on the Nigerian Stock Exchange (NSE) and a desktop-only API gateway to enable businesses to build trading platforms for their customers to trade on the NSE.
    - **InfoPool:** A directory-based software that pulls different arrays of customer data in Africa's biggest commercial banks with over 30million customers and feeds them to an admin dashboard for bank executives and managers.

Softcom Limited, Lagos, Nigeria— *Visual Designer & Marketing Comms Specialist*

MAY 2019 - FEBRUARY 2020

- Collaborated with different teams; Engineering, Client Services, and Sales, to design visually engaging content that helps drive their processes to showcase 'human-centeredness' and 'customer intimacy' in the different enterprise products, platforms or programs they were building to serve over 3million people.
- Successfully advocating for human-centred design and strategy methods within a cross-functional team that is responsible for building technology solutions that solve Africa's biggest challenges.
- Worked closely with product partners and other stakeholders to develop research plans, conduct and execute research activities, and lead insight synthesis and communication to drive forward design and product work.

Arone Technologies, Enugu, Nigeria— *Product Design Lead*

MARCH 2018 - MAY 2020

- Successfully lead the product design of pioneer products;
    - Arone Delivery (www.aronedelivery.com), Nigeria's foremost drone manufacturing startup
    - QView (www.Qview.ai), a video-based AI-enabled analytics solution for retail stores.
- Designed collateral materials for social media, and conducted highly persuasive sales and marketing presentations (pitch decks) for products/brands created within a high-tech startup.
- Enhanced brand image; increased brand awareness, and provided support and brand mind-share through advertisements, media, partnerships, and relationship marketing.

MyBodyIsMine (MyBim), Lagos Nigeria **-** Lead Designer and Brand Strategist

SEPTEMBER 2018 - NOVEMBER 2019

- Modelled sex-ed content, brand identity, social media content, interfaces, and highly persuasive sales and marketing presentations.
- Lead discovery, research and design for a new initiative to transform how teenagers learn about their bodies, sexual developments, and consent.
- Designed intentional creative experiences and digital stories through illustrations to help teenagers get the most from a comprehensive SexEd curriculum.

Funded Today via Upwork.com — *Freelance Data Analyst, Lead Gen. and Web Researcher*

MARCH 2016 - MAY 2018 (via Upwork.com)

- Liaised with clients to generate and develop contact list search-filter and target market audience list for one of US most successful crowdfunding marketing agencies.
- Acquired over 1.4million customer leads, resulting in a higher volume of confirmed sales consultations, and the largest market audience database.
- Created and maintained complete records for all prospect and customer interactions that accounted for highly successful crowdfunded products on Kickstarter and Indiegogo.

Adol Digital Arts Press, Makurdi, Benue State — *Executive Manager and Design Lead*

JANUARY, 2012 - NOVEMBER, 2014

- Directed the entire creative design team by defining processes and managing design briefs, shaping concepts and seeing it through to detailed design and implementation across a variety of devices and platforms.
- Implemented pioneering print media and IT infrastructure solutions for our clients as part of a high performing team and increased client approval ratings by 58%.
- Partnered with the executive team to identify potential new capabilities that will help the company to continue to gain market share and improve service excellence through technology platforms.

Dr Didi Emokpare
Outpost Healthcare
+1(306) 581-2626
didi.emokpare@outpost.health

11th April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: MR.CHARLES NJOKU

LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION TO UK'S GLOBAL TALENT VISA PROGRAM

It is with great pleasure that I recommend Charles Njoku for the Global Talent Visa program.

I am the Founder and CEO of Outpost Healthcare; we power a global health delivery network, bridging gaps between patients, providers, and health payments worldwide. I have over 25+ years of experience being a Doctor in the US and Canada, as well as building a product-led health tech business.

I first contacted Charles via Twitter sometime in late 2019, and since then, I have known and worked with him. I can attest to his skills, experience, character and network. Charles leads exciting and insightful conversations around design, business, and tech on Twitter with an audience of over 15,000 followers. His reach is tremendous, and this was what caught my attention in the first place. He had a clear way of communicating market complexities in comprehensive and apt ways, and his storytelling ability is second to none, in my opinion.

While it is tempting to talk about Charles's skill or talent which is incredibly vast, I would instead consider how much value Charles brings. He is a highly-skilled professional who, aside from having the capacity to deliver on expectations, has the network to get almost everything he needs to succeed.

Sometime in 2020, I consulted with Charles on how Outpost needed critical strategies for getting into the Nigerian market with its services. Within a week, where we had a couple of calls, Charles gave me insight into several strategies, consumer behaviours and case studies. He highlighted the pros and cons and how we can present a unique value proposition and stand out. I have spoken with professionals with varying industry experience in healthcare and tech, but none was as practical and hands-on as Charles shared.

Since 2021, Charles has supported Outpost as a Product and Growth Lead and transitioned to a Consultant position. He has helped us come up with several strategies to acquire healthcare partners and providers in Nigeria and create user testing frameworks for our product.

Charles has also been key in helping us recruit and hire local tech talent. He helped us hire our current Business and Partnerships Growth lead, who periodically liaises with Charles to help us continue to grow our business. His expertise, skill and network have been instrumental in helping us grow our provider network to over 100 partners across Nigeria in such a short time.

Charles is knowledgeable, innovative, resourceful and very positive thinking in his problem-solving approach. His ability to bring company strategy to life through design thinking and technical know-how is incredible.

The UK's technology sector will be very fortunate to have Charles and his new startup; his experience and skills will come in handy.

Please do not hesitate to reach out to me regarding my recommendation of Charles.

Regards,



Didi Emokpare
CEO, Outpost Healthcare

Didi Bernard Emokpare, MD ABFP CCFP

4246 ALBERT STREET, SUITE 180 REGINA SK S4S 3R9 CANADA
Telephone: (306) 581 2626 **Email:** didi@emokpare.com

CERTIFICATION & LICENSURE:

- Canadian College Of Family Practice CCFP 2016
- Board Certified - American Board of Family Practice. 2001
- Licensed to practice Medicine in the state of Illinois. 2001
- Licensed to practice Medicine in Grenada, W.I. 1996
- Licensed to practice Medicine in Trinidad & Tobago, W.I. 1995
- Licensed to practice Medicine in Nigeria. 1994
- Licensed to practice Medicine in the province of Saskatchewan, Canada. 2002
- Licensed to practice Medicine in the province of British Columbia. 2013

EDUCATION:

- Awarded CCFP Janus Scholarship for Hepatitis C Virus Management. 2012
- Continuing Medical Education for Hepatitis C Virus Management. 2009 - Present
- ACLS, BLS. 2008
- Dermatology Residency (R3): University of British Columbia. 2007-2008
- Residency in Family Practice and Community Medicine **-** Mt Sinai Hospital, Chicago, Illinois. 1998 - 2001
- ECFMG Certification - 1998
- LMCC Certification - 2009
- Teaching & Research Fellowship, St. George's University School of Medicine, Grenada, W.I. 1996-1998
- Internship **–** Port of Spain General Hospital, Trinidad & Tobago. 1995
- M.B.B.S., University of Benin Medical School, Benin Nigeria - 1994

WORK EXPERIENCE:

2015 – 2017:

Chief Medical Information Officer, ehealth Saskatchewan

Aug 2014 – 2016:

Steering committee Advisor– National Needs Assessment in Hepatitis C:
Canadian Association for the Study of the Liver (CASL) / Canadian Liver Foundation (CLF)

Sep 2007 - 2010

CEO / Lead Physician: Smartcard and Healthcare Software Application Development, Tadaka Gemini Group

Sep 2013 – present:

Chief Executive Officer, Outpost Healthcare
(Telehealth network, Mobile Health Application and Health device development)

Sep 2011 - present:

Regina Qu'Appelle Health Region: Telehealth Physician, Operating Psychiatry and Family Medicine Clinics between Regina and Fort Qu'Appelle SK
Regina Urban Care Centre (Now Outpost Health Centre): Hepatitis C Specialty Clinic
Addictions Physician, RQHR Harm Reduction Clinic

Attending Physician, Saskatchewan Drug Treatment Court Program

July 2011- 2013

Physician, University of Regina RAMS football club

July 2002 - present:

Family Practice, Regina Qu'Appelle Health Region: South End Medical Clinic, University Park Medical Clinic, Quance East Medical Clinic, Outpost Health Centre

July 2009-July 2012:

Physician, Regina Provincial Correctional Centre

July 2008 – July 2010 (Saskatchewan, Canada)

Physician, Athabasca and Keewatin Yatthe Regional Health Authorities
Family Practice and Emergency Room Physician
(Communities of La Loche, Stony Rapids, Blacklake, Patuanak, Buffalo Narrows, Fond Du Lac, Beauval, Uranium City, Ile-a-la-crosse, Dillon)
Northern Medical Services / University of Saskatchewan

June 2004 - present (Saskatchewan, Canada)

Surgical Assistant, Departments of Plastic Surgery, General Surgery, Obstetrics and Gynecology

Oct 2002 - Dec 2006 (Saskatchewan, Canada)

Family Practice and Emergency Physician, Regina Qu' Appelle Health District

Nov 2002 - present (Saskatchewan, Canada)

Physician Advisor, AIDS Programs of Southern Saskatchewan

Mar 2005 - Dec 2006 (Regina, Saskatchewan)

Physician, Regina Open Door Immigrant Resource Organization

Nov 2003 (Regina, Saskatchewan)

Physician, Regina PATS Hockey Team

Nov 2001 - Oct 2002 (Mt Sinai Hospital and Sinai Medical Group, Chicago Illinois)

Family Practice / Emergency Room Physician

May 2001-Oct 2002 (Methodist Hospital, Chicago, Illinois)

Emergency Room Physician / House Physician

Jul-Oct 2001 (US Veterans Administration Outpatient Clinic, Lafayette Indiana)

Attending Staff Physician

2000-2001 (Mt Sinai Family Practice Residency of Chicago)

Chairperson, Editorial Committee, Community Resource Center

2000-2001 (Malcolm X College, Chicago Illinois)

Visiting Clinical Teaching Faculty, Physician Assistant Program

1996-1998 (George's University Medical School, Grenada, West Indies)

Faculty Member and Clinical Tutor, Dept of Histology.
Faculty Member, Dept. of Clinical Skills

1996-1998 (General Hospital, St. George's, Grenada, West Indies)
House Officer, Emergency Department

1995-1996 (General Hospital, Port-of-Spain, Trinidad, West Indies)
Rotating Internship, Departments of Medicine, Surgery, Pediatrics, Obstetrics & Gynecology

1995-1996 (Queens Park Counseling Center, Trinidad, West Indies)
HIV/AIDS Clinical Counselor

1994-1995 (Military Hospital, Lagos, Nigeria)
Rotating Internship, Departments of Pediatrics and Medicine

RESEARCH PAPERS AND PRESENTATIONS:

- **Local Investigator, PRAIRIE Study** (Principal Investigator: Dr Gerald Minuk, Univ. of Manitoba) Prospective Anti-HCV trial of peg-Interferon and Ribavirin in subjects of First Nations/Metis and Caucasian Ethnicity: Feb 2012
- **Local Investigator, S.I.M.P.L.E Trial:** Study Investigating the Management of G1 Chronic Hepatitis C Patients treated with VICTRELIS + Peg-Riba: A Real-Life Observational Trial in Canada: Dec 2012 - 2014

- Women and AIDS: Lessons from Africa, Canadian AIDS Society - Skills Building Symposium.
  Emokpare D.
  Nov 2005 Montreal, Canada

- SHINE: A HIV/AIDS Workshop for the Education and Empowerment of African American Women

Emokpare D, Scott-Emuakpor R

- Gender and HIV/AIDS: Literature Review and Workshop Presentation - Epidemics in our Community Conference Saskatchewan Feb 2004.

Emokpare D, Scott-Emuakpor R

- Stigma and Discrimination in HIV/AIDS: Presentation to the XV International AIDS Conference, Bangkok Thailand July 2004

Emokpare D, Scott-Emuakpor R, Emokpare J.

- HIV/AIDS Stigmatization and Discrimination - Presentation to the World AIDS Symposium - Paris, France July 2003

Emokpare N. A, Scott-Emuakpor R, Emokpare D

- Behavioral Attitudes to HIV and AIDS in Grade-School Children, Chicago 2000

Emokpare D.

- Factors affecting Medication Compliance in Geriatric Patients, Chicago 2001

Emokpare D

- Prevalence of Malaria in Children under Age 5, Benin, Nigeria 1993

Emokpare D, Ediare P

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS:

- American Telemedicine Association
- COACH – Canada's Health Informatics Association
- Saskatchewan Medical Association
- Canadian College of Family Physicians

- Canadian Medical Association
- American Academy of Family Physicians
- American Society of Addiction Medicine
- American Medical Association

ACADEMIC AND CLINICAL INTERESTS

- Health Informatics, LEAN Methodology in management, mobile Health and software development
- Public Health and Safety
- Management of Hepatitis C Virus Infection in Vulnerable Populations
- Addictions Medicine

COMMUNITY- BASED AND INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION INVOLVEMENT

- Autism Resource Centre, Regina Saskatchewan: 2011 - 2014
  Board of Directors
- Lead Telehealth Physician: Outpost Health International Clinics, Haiti. 2013-Present
- Telehealth Physician and volunteer advisor: Delta State Government, Nigeria. 2013
- The Lazarus Foundation, Atlanta Georgia: 2000 - 2012
  Chairman, Board of Directors
  Director for International Programs

Adedeji Olowe
Open Banking Nigeria.
(+234)7034138291
adedeji@openbanking.ng

2nd April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

RECOMMENDATION FOR THE GLOBAL TALENT VISA PROGRAM

I am pleased to recommend Charles Njoku for the Global Talent Visa program.

I have known and worked with Charles since 2020. I hired Charles as a UX Designer during my time as CEO at Trium Networks Limited, a venture studio focused on designing, developing, and scaling digital technology products that have the potential to improve lives.

Charles showed solid technical know-how of digital products and the essential parts of delivering experiences that solve customer problems. Charles has a knack for designing experiences that solve real problems, and I consider his design thinking skills impressive. I often challenged him to expand his imagination and develop attractive yet very functional ways we could deliver some of the products we were building at the time.

Charles has an unconventional work ethic, which is very important for every entrepreneur. After his stint at Trium, I recommended him to other colleagues. Charles helped build Karma's website, an independent directory of bad loan actors. Karma has helped us cut down our loan default rates from 28% to 12% because we now have better loan history and background check information. For our Lendsqr's 'Buy-Now-Pay-Later' product, Charles's interaction design helped increase our conversation rates when customers learn about our product on the website and

sign up from about 32% to 48%. He also created interactive visuals that communicated how important Open Banking's work is and how it worked; this piece helped us onboard more stakeholders (about 26 more) and closed an undisclosed amount of funding in grants.
Sometime in 2021, I recommended Charles's service to Onepipe, shortly after they raised a seed round of $3.5M. While Charles didn't make the raise happen, they were consistent feedback from stakeholders about how the pitch deck design and the interactive visuals of the product's value proposition made their decision easier.

Charles is very versatile, with technical know-how across many tech skills/disciplines. He knows everything from product design, interaction design, animation, product thinking, product strategy, front-end engineering, etc. Aside from his core design skill, he is also a passionate salesman; he will go to lengths to sell you an idea or a concept because he genuinely believes in it. That has made him an almost invaluable asset in the technology ecosystem.

It was no surprise when he informed me of starting his venture, Spire. In my 20+years of experience in building products, one of the most challenging things to scale is the impact and ROI of customer feedback on the products we build. Charles's new venture is at the centre of helping us solve this problem, and I am rooting for him to succeed. The UK will benefit from his versatile experience, skills and his motivation to always find real problems to solve. Charles won't stop, and that is because he is self-motivated to succeed. His collaborative and cross-functional skills that I can testify to will also come in handy in helping him grow his startup in the UK. I predict that he will be at the forefront of the UK's technology sector advancement.

If you have any questions, don't hesitate to contact me.

Regards,

Adédeji Olowe
Founder & Trustee, Open Banking Nigeria
www.linkedin.com/in/adedejiolowe

Adédèjì Olówè

+234 703 413 8291 | adedeji@olowe.com | www.dejiolowe.com

Profile

- Founder and Trustee of the Open Technology Foundation, nonprofit driving advocacy and implementation of Open Banking in the Nigeria financial industry
- Transformational experience in digital payments, retail banking, finance, performance management, customer service, operations, and back-office automation at various financial institutions

Professional experience

Trium Limited.
Venture Capital and Venture Building company with a focus on technology across Africa and a vision to transform the continent using technology, capital, and expertise

Managing Director/Chief Executive Officer (March 2018 till date)

- Venture investments and portfolio management of technology startups with proven scaling potentials within Africa with a focus on Nigeria
- Identifying and delivery of the opportunities that exist within the immediate ecosystem to create value through venture building
- Strategic digital advisory across payments, API business, product architecture, and technology implementations
- Board Member: Woven Finance
- Board Member: Sparkle Bank
- Board Member: The Payment Company, part of the Access Bank Plc. Group
- Board Member: Coronation GPS
- Board Member: Paystack
- Board Observer: Clane

Open Banking, Nigeria
An Open API initiative; created as a non-partisan and non-financial API standard for Nigerian financial services. The vision of Open Banking Nigeria is to help reduce financial exclusion and boost Nigeria's innovation quotient

Founder and Trustee (June 2017 till date)

- Working with banks, global industry professionals, and fintechs to define an open and non-partisan set of Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) to be adopted by banks, fintechs, and other stakeholders
- Advocacy with the Central Bank of Nigeria, Nigerian banks, Fintechs and global Open API players to understand and embrace the concept of Open Banking to improve customer convenience, increase innovation and reduce time and cost of technical integration

SystemSpecs Limited.
A reputable and leading Fintech in Africa with over two decades of innovation which has delivered successful and award-winning electronic payments, collections, payroll, and Treasury Single Accounts solutions

Executive Director, Products and Services (February 2017 – March 2018)

- Drove the transformation from a government focused business into retail payments and services company
- Implemented best of breed back-office processes to improve customers, banks, and partner satisfaction, reduce the turnaround time of processes and reduce manual intervention and touchpoints
- Engaged with partners, banks, and other stakeholders to open capabilities and become a financial infrastructure company and significantly increase revenue share from APIs and other collaborative engagements
- Developed the digital lending infrastructure products to become a significant revenue line in partnership with major banks and Fintechs such as Access Bank Payday, FCMB, Page Financials, OneFI, etc. $11M lent to over 200,000 users on the platform between commencement in October 2017 and March 2018 with each loan completed within 30 seconds

Atlas Mara Limited.
A financial services holding company formed to undertake the acquisition of target banks in Africa with the objective of becoming a leading financial services group in the continent.

Vice President, Cards and Digital Payments (October 2016 – February 2017)

- Developed the strategy for the transformation of the card business from a cost center to a profit-making SBU
- Kickstarted the implementation of a state-of-the-art instant issuance of cards and PIN to reduce the turnaround time of card issuance and provide a significant boost to the card base
- Worked in partnership with CGAP, a part of the World Bank, to develop a digital payment solution targeted at reducing financial exclusion in Southern Africa
- Kickstarted the implementation of a digital wallet system, white-labeled for large retail entities in Southern, Eastern, and West Africa

Verve International.
Verve is the largest electronic card scheme in Nigeria, having over 50% market share, with eyes on the international market.

Advisory Board Member (October 2013 – September 2016)

- Provided bank-oriented customer feedback, which is incorporated into the forming and execution of the company's strategy
- Provided objective and constructive input and advice to the management for both the immediate and the long-term
- Provided original views and perspectives normally unrecognized by shareholders, management, and employees
- Helped to drive innovation and creativity at the executive-level for the company

Fidelity Bank Plc.
A top tier 2 commercial bank transforming into a tier 1 bank with significant emphasis on Retail, SME, and Digital Banking.

Divisional Head, Electronic Banking (June 2014 – September 2016)

- Led the implementation of the Ebanking Transformation Strategy to move Fidelity Bank to be the bank with the best customer experience for electronic services
- Revamped products, processes, and technology for world-class customer experience, stability, availability, and financial performance. Delivered profit of N14B over 2.5 years.

- Automated back-office processes (settlement, reconciliation, chargeback, cards, online and instant banking), which has achieved a significant reduction in TAT, headcount and opened up new opportunities for products such as bulk transactions (transfers, airtime, and cardless withdrawals)
- Drove the Bank wide-area network's transformation by increasing average bandwidth per branch by 298% and global aggregate bandwidth pool by 202%, with total cost reduction by 9.3%. The network optimization provided real value cost savings in excess of $10M per year
- Supervised the implementation of a world-class and lean disaster recovery center under a tight budget and short deadline of 6 months

United Bank for Africa Plc.
One of the largest financial institutions in Nigeria and West Africa with total assets in excess of US$14bn and over 700 branches spread across three continents.

Group Head, Cards (November 2011 – February 2014)

- Responsible for the profitability, customer experience, and product performance of UBA Card portfolio in Nigeria and 18 African countries
- Orchestrated the turnaround of the card business; grew annual revenue from less than N1.5B in 2011 to more N3.5B a year by 2013
- Drove massive cost reduction in key cost lines; lowest card production cost in the market and at least N1.2B saved from card plastic cost; card hosting; transaction processing and other ancillary services within 24 months
- Implemented customer segmentation for enhanced customer experience, improved service, and enhanced profitability. Introduced premium card products into the product mix with the launch of UBA World MasterCard, the only metal body debit card in Africa. Currently driving segmentation across UBA Africa with the launch of Visa Gold and Platinum in select markets and extending MasterCard to 14 key markets
- Ensured that card products and processes complied and surpassed all regulatory and compliance requirements such as ISO, CBN, PCI DSS, etc.

Senior Manager, Performance Improvement Initiatives (March 2008 – October 2011)

- Designed and implemented an end-to-end technology platform and processes to automate the Management Profitability Report (MPR) and Financial Statements (FINSTAT). The system delivers reports *daily* to both web/desktop and mobile devices securely while empowering the organization

to have a more in-depth insight into the corporate performance not possible with the traditional monthly MPR and FINSTAT

- Implemented a Performance Management framework (policy and technology) across the group using a bespoke business intelligence system. This platform provides enhanced operational and sales performance dashboards, reports, and analytics for line officers, supervisors, and executive management at a fractional cost of commercial software
- Developed the technology platform and processes necessary for the continuous performance assessment and bi-annual appraisal of over 13,000 staff across 16 countries

First City Monument Bank Plc.
Pioneer indigenous merchant bank and one of the leading universal banks in Nigeria with assets in excess of US$4b, offering a wide range of retail and investment banking services.

Head, Business Automation (March 2006 – January 2008)

- Led the development of a proprietary application framework, Infopool, to extend the core banking application's capabilities. The solution also integrated the largest enterprise data sources into a distributed warehouse with a consistent interface. The system reduced the need for extra banking application licenses and was responsible for savings of about $1M that could have been spent on user access licensing fees
- Implemented a Performance Management framework (policy and technology) in collaboration with the Finance Division using a custom-built business intelligence system. Features included highly automated performance and management profitability reports
- Technical Project Lead for the General Shared Services using various hardware/software components. The implementation realized a direct saving of $1.5M as opposed to bids submitted by top international technology consultancies

Access Bank Plc.
Access Bank is a leading financial services provider in Nigeria, with an asset base of over US$16 billion and over 600 branches and 11 subsidiaries in Africa and the United Kingdom.

Head, Electronic Banking and Web Management (October 2002 – February 2006)

- Management of the electronic banking products. Responsible for the corporate web infrastructure: website, intranet, and other content platforms

- Implemented Infopool, an extensive web application that provided sales and operational reporting features and extended the capabilities of the core banking software via integration
- Technical resource for the successful three-way Access Bank, Marina International Bank, and Capital Bank merger in 2005. Individually, responsible for information management via the merger website and survey management for the staff of the three constituent entities

Standard Trust Bank Plc.

[NYSC] Relationship Manager, Internet Banking (July 2001 – June 2002)

- Managed requests for Internet banking by the bank's customers
- Implemented an intranet for Standard Virtual, a subsidiary of Standard Trust Bank Plc. using Microsoft Active Server Pages and SQL Server 7 on a Windows NT platform

Education

- MSc. Engineering with Business Management (Distinction) / King's College London (2011)
- BEng in Electrical Engineering (2:1) / Federal University of Technology, Akure (2001)

Other Experiences

- Active blogging at https://dejiolowe.com
- Founder, Open Banking Nigeria [https://openbanking.ng]
- Founder, Lendsqr [https://Lendsqr.com]

Adédèjì Olówè
adedeji@olowe.com
+234 703 413 8291

Edmund Olotu
Blochq Limited
(+234)8073828767
edmund@blochq.io

12th April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: MY RECOMMENDATION OF CHARLES NJOKU FOR UK's GLOBAL TALENT VISA

My name is Edmund Olotu, Founder and Chief Innovation Officer of Bloc. Bloc is a PCI compliant and ISO 27001 certified and Licensed FinTech and Banking infrastructure-as-a-service for African FinTech. Nominated by the London Stock Exchange Group as one of 100 companies to inspire Africa in 2019, Bloc offers an exhaustive set of building blocks (infrastructure, compliance, customers and capital) to new/existing companies to help them provide financial services to their customers.

Charles, whom I have known and worked with over the past 3years, is one of the very young promising technology entrepreneurs in Nigeria's digital technology ecosystem. He has established himself as the go-to for anything UX Design, Product Growth and Strategy. Asides from how knowledgeable and passionate I know Charles to be, he also has an incredible knack for building connections across all levels, from his peers to industry operators and veterans. I have had the opportunity to engage him first-hand in very productive conversations around

building scalable products and collaborating with other industry players to execute strategies that work.

In 2021, I contracted Charles as a product manager to manage the design and development of one of our GenZ-focused fintech products - Moolah Message. Moolah is the sleekest way to send small chunks of money to your Whatsapp contacts without asking for their account details. Charles helped audit the UX Design and reconceptualise the customer journey and Go-To-Market strategy. His ideas and product direction were instrumental in the new and simplified customer journey of Moolah Message, one that has seen a tremendous reduction in the amount of time taken for a user to send their first cash via Moolah. During this time, he also helped facilitate a potential merger & acquisition of a growing social commerce product.

I recommend Charles Njoku for the Global Talent Visa program in all confidence. His startup Spirē, which is like nothing we have seen here in Nigeria, will be given a new home in the UK, offering him all the resources to build a global company successfully. With all of the experience, expertise and network Charles has been able to make; it is a great addition to continue to build the same in the UK and globally.

If they are any questions about my recommendation of Charles, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Regards,



Edmund Olotu
Founder & Chief Innovation Officer, Bloc.

Contact

edmund.olotu@gmail.com

www.linkedin.com/in/edmundolotu (LinkedIn)
www.techadvance.ng (Company)
www.gpayafrica.com (Company)

Top Skills

Cloud Computing
SaaS
Start-ups

Honors-Awards

Finalist
Finalist
Finalist
Recipient
London Stock Exchange Group “100 companies to inspire Africa”

Edmund Olotu

Founder & Chief Innovation Officer @ Bloc
Lagos, Nigeria

Summary

Technology Development Expertise and Seed Stage entrepreneur. Focus on developing technologies and funding innovative concepts that aid in Social Development.

Specialties: Technology Development, Outsourcing, Technology License Agreements, Research Partnership Agreements, Business Analysis and Valuations.

Experience

Bloc
Founder/Chief Innovation Officer
December 2010 - Present (11 years 5 months)
Global

PCI compliant and ISO 27001 certified and Licensed FinTech and Banking Infrastructure as a service for African FinTech. Nominated by London Stock Exchange Group as one of 100 companies to inspire Africa in 2019.

Generate4schools/Causemetrix LLc
Founding Investor
May 2011 - November 2018 (7 years 7 months)
United States

Causemetrix/Generate4Schools provides a platform that enables the use of commissions from recurring transaction revenues to fund social programs- our first program is for underfunded schools in the USA using merchant account premiums from local businesses in partnership with FirstData

G-Pay Instant Payments LTD
Founder/CEO
January 2011 - September 2017 (6 years 9 months)
Nigeria

Utility infrastructure and front end payment processing company.

Scratch card, POS, Online/Mobile and cash postpaid/prepaid payment processing for Electricity Distribution companies in Nigeria covering 15 states. Processing over NGN12Billion per year in electricity utility bills.

SuperGeeks Services & Solutions
Co-Founder
April 2013 - July 2016 (3 years 4 months)
Nigeria

Innovative after sales and support services for the burgeoning personal consumer electronics segment in Nigeria- operators of the Gadget Protection Plan in partnership with Cornerstone Insurance

HiTV Media LTD
General Manager- Strategy and International Business Development
January 2009 - December 2010 (2 years)
Lagos, Nigeria

Africa's fastest growing PayTV company. Responsible for several key initiatives including but not limited to the acquisition of Tinapa Studios, Launching the 1Music Channel, Publisher of Hi-Magazine and the international sale of HIMedia's Nollywood and Nigerian Music Channel to satellite television platforms across Africa, Europe, the USA and Canada

Molecmo Nanobiotechnologies Inc., Now Novira Therapeutics
Co-Founder and CFO
September 2006 - November 2008 (2 years 3 months)

Acquired by Johnson and Johnson Pharma Nov 2015 for $600Million- Venture backed (USD$26Million) Antiviral Drug Discovery Company based in Massachusetts/Philadelphia. 2008 recipient of the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation Award for Global Health. Finalist in three of the largest global business plan competitions- 2008.

Openlink Software Company Inc.
Business Development and Corporate Venturing Associate
June 2006 - June 2007 (1 year 1 month)

Education

Harvard University
MA Management, Finance and Control · (2006 - 2008)

University of Nottingham - Nottingham University Business School

M.Sc with Distinction, Science and technology

Entrepreneurship · (2003 - 2005)

The University of Manchester

B.Eng, Mechanical Engineering · (2000 - 2003)

softcom

Odulu Ikogi Amos
Softcom Limited
(+234)8141110266
ann@softcom.xyz

12th April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
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N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: REFERENCE LETTER FOR CHARLES NJOKU

On behalf of Softcom Limited, I recommend Charles Njoku for the Global Talent Visa program. Charles was a member of our cross-functional agile marketing team famously known as 'MCC'. This team was responsible for delivering some of the most iconic marketing and growth strategies for businesses and government social programs. I have known and worked with Charles since 2019 and can attest to his skill, character and experience.

Softcom is a 14-year-old technology company in Nigeria with experience building solutions for businesses, enabling access and fighting poverty through digital technology. Softcom's products and expertise have powered various initiatives and growth projects for MTN, Cocacola, GB Foods, Rockefeller Foundation, MTN Foundation, ARM, Bank of Industry, Ardova PLC, Samsung, NIBSS, Gino, NAICOM and many other organisations. Softcom has worked with these organisations to deepen customer intimacy through its marketing initiatives, and innovative digital products to increase their revenue, and improve decision-making.

As its Marketing Manager, I lead the team Charles was an integral part of, and in collaboration with Charles, we were responsible for engaging stakeholders and clients on behalf of Softcom, consulting on growth strategies for their business and products, creating new digital products, platforms as well as programs to reach their target markets/audience via organically driven initiatives.

Charles was actively responsible for designing user interfaces, carrying out market and product research, illustrating concepts and creating marketing strategies. He also provided technical support across different teams and projects. He actively liaised and collaborated with me to implement marketing strategies for Honeywell Group for their 'Spaghetti Mini' launch to a carefully curated audience of 100+ people to validate market viability. Upon validation, Charles's designs were used to reach over 2million consumers across 10+ local markets across the country.

We also worked together on the relaunch of Forte Oil as Ardova Oil, we were able to increase their social media engagements by 108% as well as position them as a leading 'automobile engine oil' producer and distributor. This led to the renewal of our marketing management contracts 5months earlier than expected.

Charles designed the 2020 Impact Report of N-power and Tradermoni. N-Power is a National Social Investment Programme and TraderMoni is one of three microcredit products of the Government Enterprise and Empowerment Programme (GEEP). Working with Product, Business Development and Client Services teams, Charles designed visuals to interpret complex technical details of Softcom's technology impact on over 2million beneficiaries of the program.

I can attest to Charles's collaborative, research and design skills, he showed several times that he will do all it takes to get the job done. His interpersonal skill was very evident during his time at Softcom; his day-to-day interactions required him to work across teams, multiple departments, and all levels of staff, including management, and he handled it well.

Softcom HQ
15B Oduduwa Crescent, Ikeja GRA,
Ikeja, Lagos, Nigeria.

softcom

Recently, I learned he started his own software company called Spire, and I was more than happy for him. Spirē's value is not so hard to explain; at Softcom, we also have a product called Useforms, and it shares a similar value proposition with Spire. I believe Charles is solving a real problem and I am rooting for him to succeed.

Charles will be an incredible addition to the UK's technology sector; his versatile experience and skills and his motivation to solve problems will be very beneficial. I also urge that he gets all the support he needs in helping him grow his startup in the UK.

Please do not hesitate to reach out to me regarding my recommendation of Charles.

Regards,



Odulu Ikogi Antu Amos
Brand Marketing and Communications Manager,
Softcom Limited

Google Developer Groups
Lagos

Aniedi Udo-Obong
Google Africa
(+234)8067084142
aniediudo@gmail.com

12th April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

RE: RECOMMENDATION LETTER FOR CHARLES NJOKU FOR GLOBAL TALENT VISA

My name is Aniedi Udo-Obong and I am a Program Manager on Google's Developer Ecosystem in Sub-Saharan Africa. I currently lead Google's Developer community offerings - Google Developer Student Clubs (GDSC) and Google Developer Groups (GDG), through which I am responsible for driving awareness, adoption, advocacy and feedback for Google's products and platforms for the past 6yrs.

My job essentially puts me at the forefront of interacting with both emerging as well as established technology leaders around Africa and it is how I have come to know Charles. Before we formally met, I have known Charles Njoku to be an exceptional technology professional in Nigeria's tech ecosystem going by testimonials from his peers and engagements I have come across either on social media or in-person and it didn't take long for our paths to cross sooner than later.

Charles has spoken or sat on panels organized by at least 4 different Google Developer Groups in Nigeria. Each of these events had no less than 200 attendees with as high as 3,000 attendees. When he is not speaking about feedback and digital products, he is sharing insights into building digital products using Google's technologies. Recently, he was the only male in an all-female panel hosted by the GDG's Women Techmakers event in honour of

Google Developer Groups
Lagos

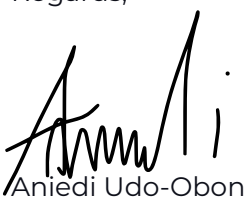
International Women's Day, a testament to his recognized ability to engage in progressive conversations that largely impact the ecosystem.

During GoogleDevFest Lagos and Ibadan 2021, Spire, which Charles founded, was our feedback partner. Spire helped us collect over 300 feedback from participants who attended and shared their experiences with us. This has proved invaluable because, for the first time, we have direct insight into the participant experience during DevFest.

Charles shared with me that he intends to continue building Spire in the UK and I completely support this decision. I am recommending Charles for the Global Talent Visa because I believe the UK will provide him with an enabling environment and access to a global market to help him grow Spire. He will also be contributing immensely to the UK's digital technology sector with his expertise, network and skills.

I am writing this recommendation to vouch that Charles will continue to do incredibly well, he has all of my support.

Regards,



Aniedi Udo-Obong
Program Manager,
Google's Developer Ecosystem in Sub-Saharan Africa.
https://www.linkedin.com/in/aniediudo/

November 26, 2020

Dear **Charles,**

It gives me great pleasure to offer you the position of **ALX Platform UX/UI Designer** at ALX.

As you are aware, we are on our fast-growing moonshot, and **we are excited to have you continue with us in our journey**. Our vision will not be achieved individually, or through the power of one. It will be enabled by a powerful community that is **courageous** enough to dream as big as the vision, **resilient** enough to persist until we get there, **adventurous** enough to innovate and discover, **humble** enough to ask questions and learn from others and **initiative-driven** to make things happen.

We are a fully remote organization, meaning you can work anywhere in the world that you choose!

The suggested start date is **January 11, 2021.**.

I am pleased to offer you an initial cash compensation of **35,000 USD salary** gross per annum.

If you accept this offer to join us on this exciting journey, our People Team will contact you to support you in your transition into ALX.

Charles, we are honoured at the prospect of having you join the ALX team! Great organizations are made possible when passionate, outstanding people like you come together in pursuit of a shared vision to develop millions of high-impact leaders.

We are excited to have you onboard!

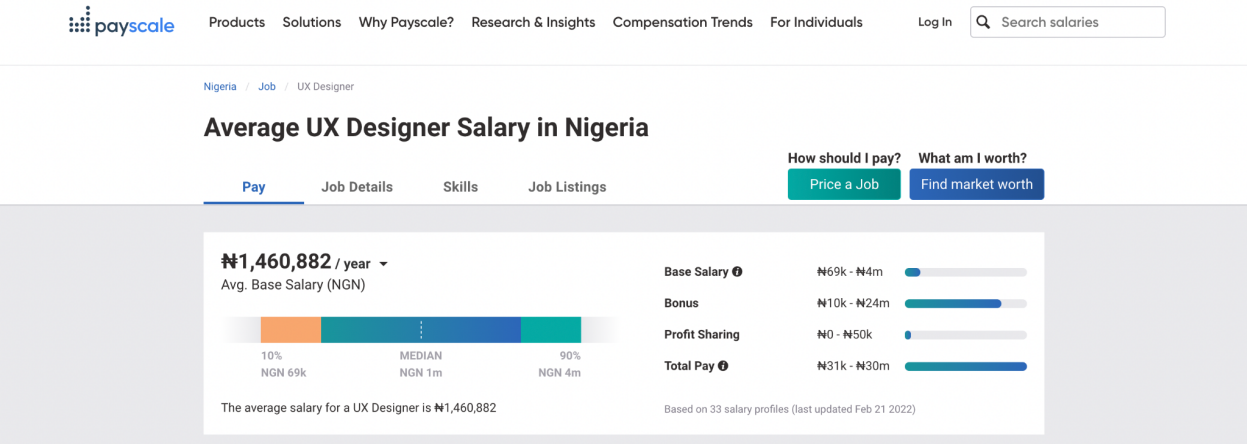
Warm regards,



Persis Merab Ashers
ALX People Operations

This letter does not create any legally binding obligations and its content is subject entirely to the execution of a formal agreement.

SALARY STATISTICS FOR MY ROLE IN NIGERIA via payscale.com



$1 = N575

Annual Avg. Gross UX Designers Salary in Nigeria in USD = $8,500

My Annual Gross = $35,000+

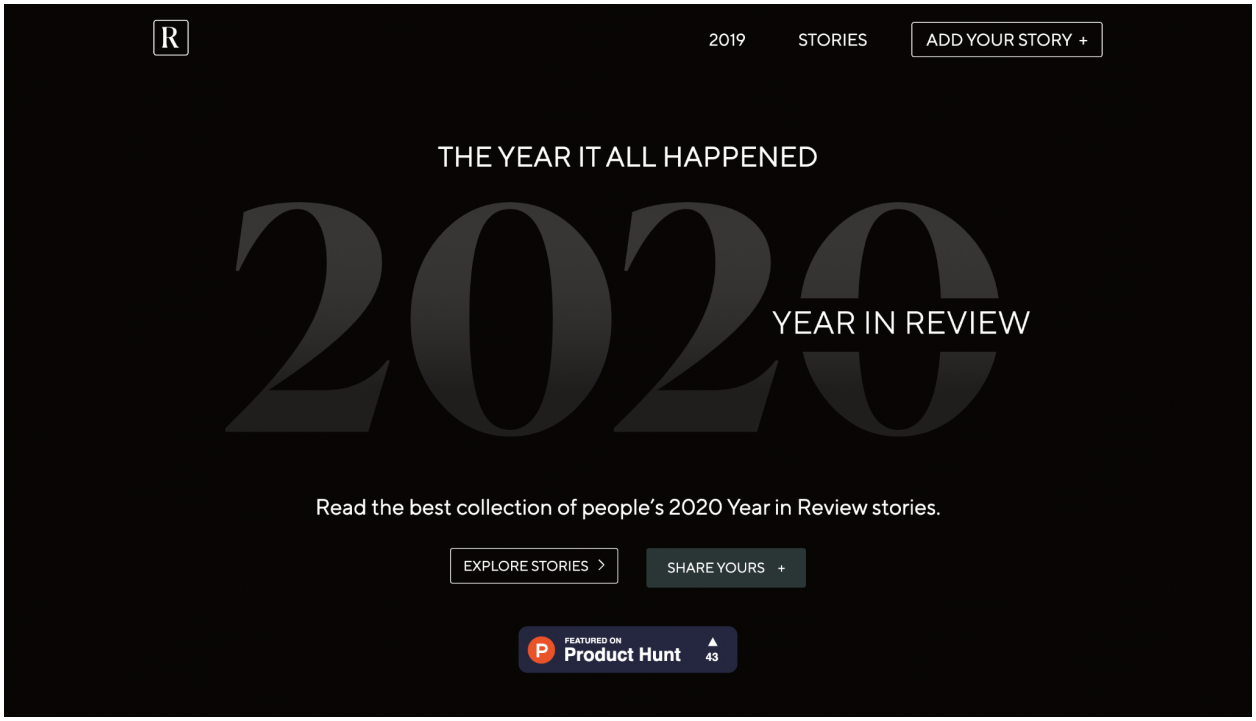
PRODUCT NAME: Retrogram
WEBSITE: www.retrogram.co (formerly www.retro.xyz)

MY ROLE/CONTRIBUTIONS:
Content Creation and UX/UI Design

ABOUT PRODUCT:
Starting in 2019, Retrogram is a collection of people's Year in Review stories. At the beginning of every year, we have over 1,700 people reading and sharing these stories.

FIGMA LINK:
https://www.figma.com/file/cfp42tnQ6BER7Iye1YQZdC/Retrotry?node-id=731%3A0

PRODUCT HUNT:
https://www.producthunt.com/posts/retrogram



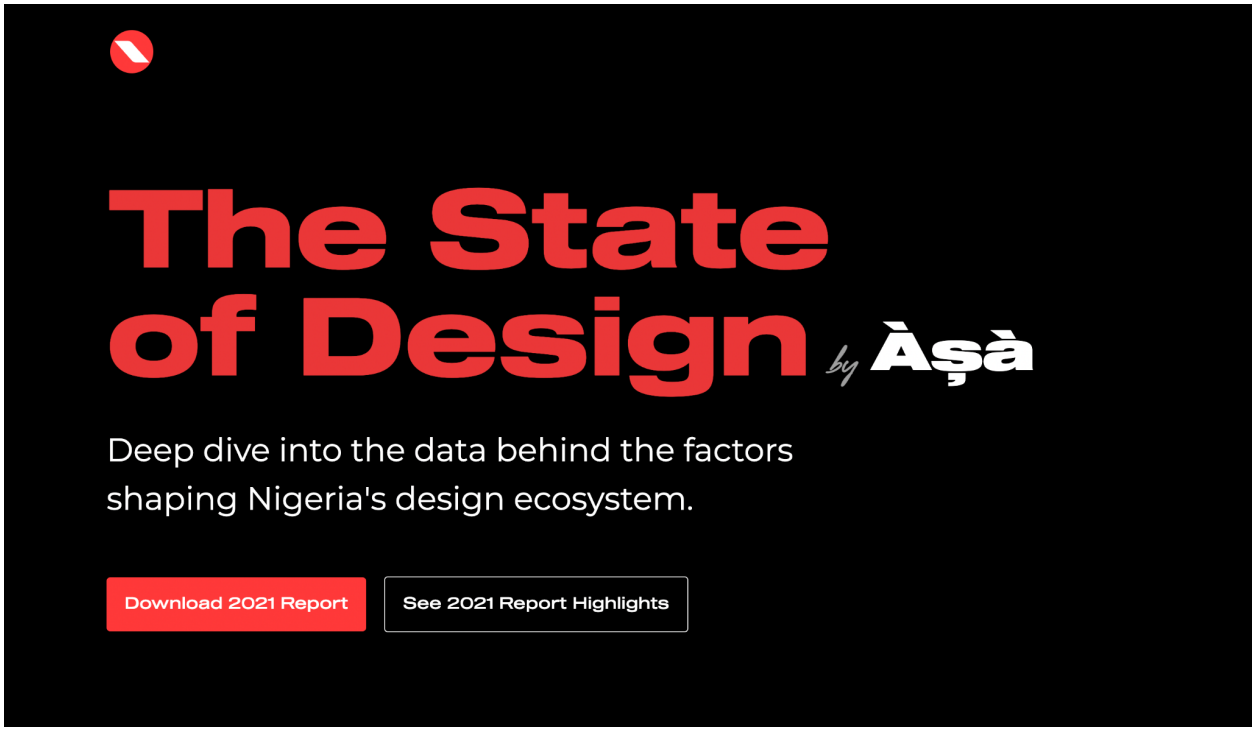
INITIATIVE NAME: State of Design by Asá
COMMUNITY: Asá Coteriè
WEBSITE: www.stateof.design

MY ROLE/CONTRIBUTIONS:
Project Lead, Content Creation, Web Design, Research and Data Analysis

ABOUT ASÀ:
Asá is a multi-disciplinary design community of some of the finest designers in Nigeria. Together, we embark on several design activities; meetups, webinars, conversations, conferences, challenges, etc focused on improving the design practice in Nigeria

ABOUT STATE OF DESIGN
Created by Àṣà in 2020, the State of Design is an open and collaborative resource for understanding the complex economic, social, and cultural factors shaping Nigeria's design ecosystem. The survey questions that form an integral part of the report will cover careers, salaries, skill-building, design education, remote work, and more—gleaning remarkable insights from designers at different levels in Nigeria.

GITHUB REPO:
https://github.com/madebycharles/stateofdesign_ng



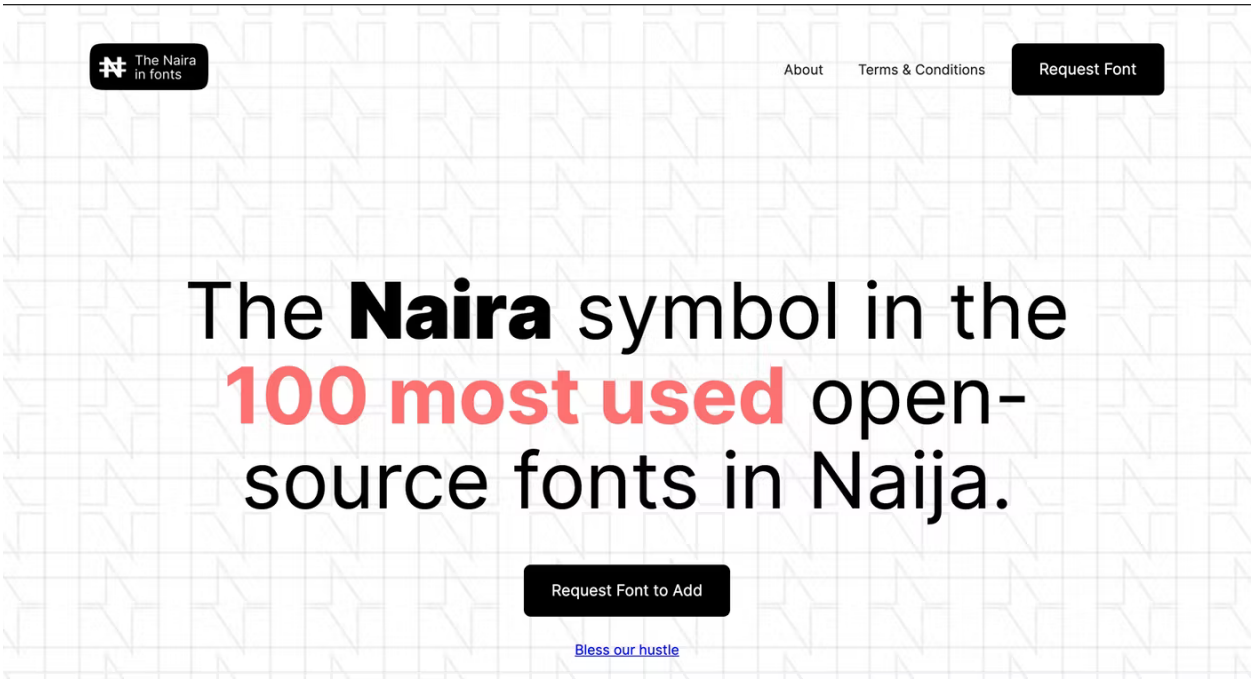
INITIATIVE NAME: The Naira in Fonts
WEBSITE: www.thenairainfonts.com

MY ROLE/CONTRIBUTIONS:
Project Lead, Content Creation, and Web Design

ABOUT PROJECT:
Nigeria is home to over 200Million people and have one of the highest immigrant population across the world, yet it's currency; 'The Naira' is not a common feature on computer keyboards and fonts worldwide. As a result, we started this project to add the Naira symbol in 100 most used open-source fonts in Nigeria.

GITHUB REPO:
https://github.com/madebycharles/thenairainfonts

PRODUCT HUNT
https://www.producthunt.com/posts/the-naira-in-fonts



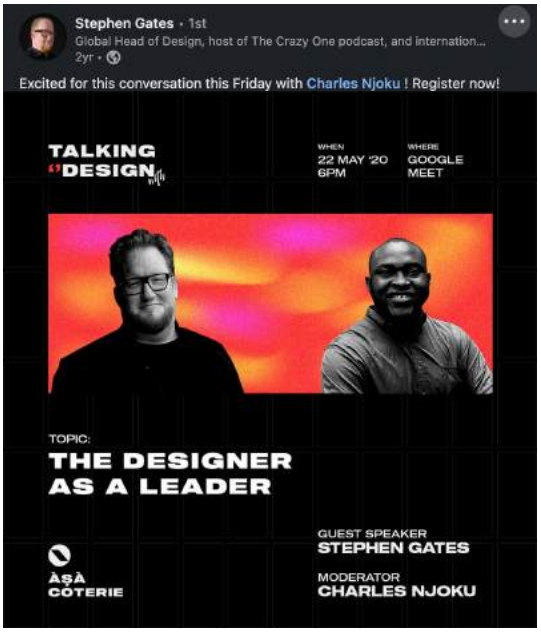
SOCIAL MEDIA WEEK LAGOS, 2020
SMW Lagos is Lagos is a week-long conference dubbed as one of Africa's Biggest Tech Events.
EVENT LINK:
https://socialmediaweeklagos2020.sched.com/event/YFSS/human-centered-design-redesigning-the-food-delivery-experience

ATTENDANCE TO MY SESSION: 107

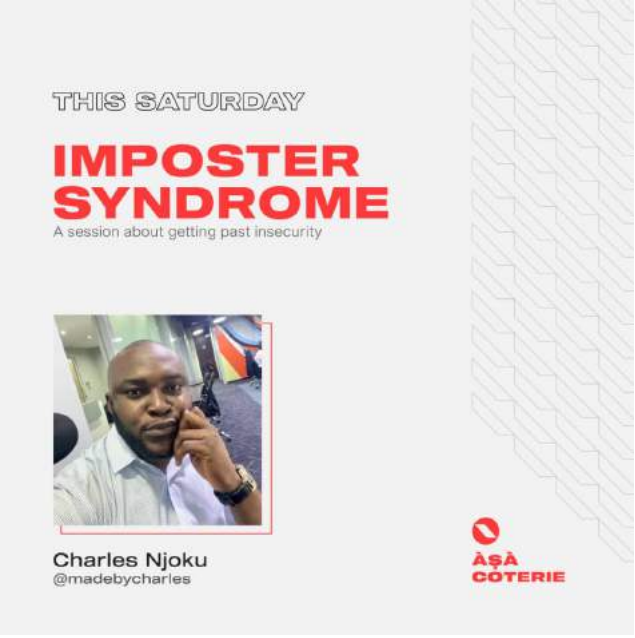
RESEARCH DOCUMENT FOR MY TALK:
https://docs.google.com/document/d/1uggiwEKX4OdZMJ3L_ZDFws5iyJ5mMMZ907L_WHR_Nx0/edit?usp=sharing





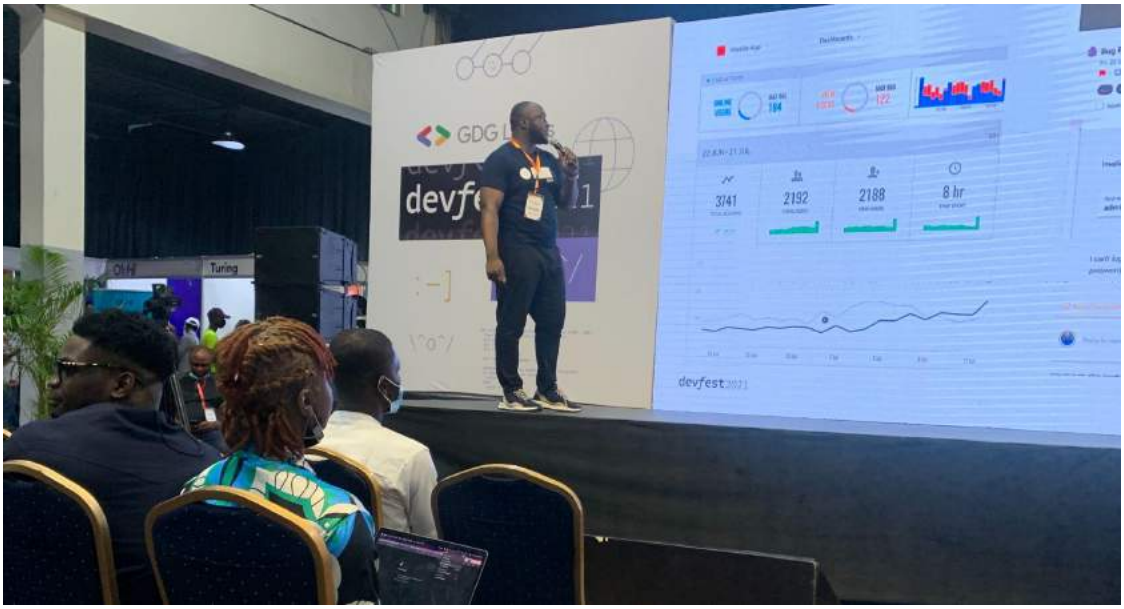


Link to Session: TDwGates
Views: 774



Link to Session: Imposter Syndrome
Views: 201

GOOGLE DEVFEST LAGOS 2021



Video Reel of Event: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SqLF5ldmd1Y
ATTENDANCE: 1,000+

AFRICA NXT, Lagos 2022

AFRICA NXT (formerly Social Media Week Lagos) focused on; REIMAGINING OUR APPROACH TO INNOVATION. RENEWING OUR COLLECTIVE COMMITMENT TO AFRICA'S PROSPERITY.

EVENT LINKS:
https://emamo.com/event/africanxt2022/s/leveraging-insights-feedback-from-african-consumers-to-build-world-class-products-NP620W

ATTENDANCE: 97 Live, 231 Virtually





2022 Google Women Techmakers Lagos Panel; #ProgressnotPerfection

ORGANIZER: www.gdglagos.com

INVITATION EMAIL:

Invitation as a panelist: WTM Lagos International Women's Day Event

OM makinde.mide@gmail.com
Thu, 17 Mar 2022 12:04:07 PM +0100 · INBOX
To "charles" <charles@spire.africa>
Cc "maryannonuoha901" <maryannonuoha901@gmail.com>,
"Jadesola Anoma" <anomajadesola@gmail.com>
Tags
Security TLS Learn more

Hello, Charles!

Trust you're doing great.

Olamide here. I'm reaching out on behalf of Google Women TechMakers, Lagos. For Google WTM, Lagos Chapter's International Women's Day this year, we would be focusing on "Progress, not Perfection" as the theme. We want to encourage women to celebrate their wins, whether seemingly little or big. We want to emphasize the importance of reflecting on the journey thus far and applauding their efforts and progress.

We would love for you to be a part of our commemoration by giving being a part of our panel session centred on the theme, #ProgressNotPerfection. The event is scheduled for 10 am on Saturday, April 9th, 2022, at Gbagada, Lagos. I'll send more details and the agenda in a subsequent email.

We think that, given the record of such incredible work you are doing in the tech space, you'd be in a great position to deliver this speech and drive the message home.

Would you be willing and available to join the panel? I look forward to your prompt response. Happy to answer any questions you may have.

Best regards,
Olamide Makinde
For the organizing team, WTM Lagos IWD 2022.





Hult Prize is a yearly global competition founded by Mr. Ahmed Ashkar (www.hultprize.org) which is open students all over the world including Nigeria.

I was selected by it's UNN-Team to help mentor over 30 students who were being prepped to compete at the local and regional finals. I helped learn about their individual interests and strengths and put them in teams that aligned to their interests.

I also ran sessions on the 'Lean Startup' process and empowered with tools to rapidly build on their ideas, test and eventually pitch.



Treford
Design, Build and Scale Products

+234 903 757 0837
+234 706 192 3105
www.treford.org
admissions@treford.org

15th April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

Reference Letter For Charles Njoku For UK'S Global Talent VISA

I write to recommend Charles for the prestigious UK Global Talent VISA with the utmost confidence in the immense value he brings to wherever he finds himself.

I have known Charles first from afar as a fan for over three years, where I continually watched him devote time to inspiring other young people looking to build successful design careers as he has done. Then I finally got the privilege of having him join our design faculty at Treford in 2021 to mentor our product design students.

Lots of our design alumni have gone on to successfully land UI/UX jobs with top companies as a result. For me, it's amazing to see him always consistently make time to do this for both younger and more experienced designers simply making time to consistently share helpful insights despite how hectic his daily schedule is.

I have also seen the impact Charles brings as an entrepreneur, beyond inspiring people he is building a company that has also provided job opportunities for both designers and software engineers, helping them realize their dreams and become financially independent in the process.

Charles steadily strives to create value as a world-class product designer, as a design coach to aspiring and practising designers and also as an entrepreneur constantly looking to build digital products that solve problems at scale.

I am confident he will bring these same values he has been consistently known for to the UK Tech environment and I strongly recommend him for consideration.

Warm Regards

Osemudiame Harry Enaholo
Co-Founder and CEO at Treford

Perxels

11th April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

REFERENCE LETTER TO UK'S GLOBAL TALENT VISA PROGRAM FOR CHARLES NJOKU

My name is Abiodun Fiwa Okunade, Founder and CEO of Perxels Design School, Nigeria. I am pleased to attest to Charles Njoku's contributions, support and mentorship to our students as well as recommend him for the Global Talent Visa program.

With the aid of experienced industry professionals as mentors, we provide design education to aspiring UI/UX designers and also help designers grow their expertise level by exposing them to real-life cases. We currently have a community of over 5,000 designers and have trained/mentored over 700.

Charles is one of our highly-rated industry mentors, he is well known in the design ecosystem in Nigeria for his pragmatic and practical approach to the design. He consistently leads conversations in design and shares strong opinions on the collective impact of good design. On numerous occasions, Charles has spent time with us mentoring on careers in design, sharing his thoughts and insights on other specialized design topics.

I am proud to say Charles is Perxel's biggest supporter, he has made the most referrals of aspiring designers to our school. In March 2021, he also contributed a sponsorship donation to support 10 aspiring designers to join Perxels.

The UK's technology sector will be very fortunate to have Charles and his startup; his experience and skills will come in handy.

Please do not hesitate to reach out to me regarding my recommendation of Charles.

Regards,

Abiodun Fiwa Okunade
CEO, Perxels Design School

W: perxels.com
E: info@perxels.org
T: +234 8135 3696 80

COMPANY NAME: Arone Technologies
WEBSITE: www.qview.ai
PRODUCT:

- QView: Smart AI Camera
- QInsight: Video Insights & Analytics Dashboard

ABOUT PRODUCT:
QView captures customer in-store video data at various touch-points and provides insights via QInsights to enable retail stores to personalize intelligent customer experiences and improve business operations.

MY ROLE/CONTRIBUTION:
UX Research, Product Design and Frontend Engineering

RESEARCH DOCUMENTATION:
http://charlesnjoku.com/exploring-with-ai-video-analytics.html
https://www.behance.net/gallery/90408423/QViewai-Web-Design-for-AI-Video-Analytics-Startup

GITHUB REPO:
https://github.com/madebycharles/Interface-Dev

PRODUCT DEMO:
https://projects.invisionapp.com/prototype/QInsight-cjwg6wx8b009d4301v0s356uc

NEWS FEATURES:
https://www.benjamindada.com/zenith-tech-fair-hackathon-winners/

COMMERCIAL SUCCESS:
We couldn't scale QView's adoption due to the expensive technical and operational requirements to make 1 device. But we sold about 3 prototypes and got a grant of $5,000.

COMPANY NAME: Pishure Technologies
WEBSITE(s): www.getpishure.com, www.bavatars.co
MY ROLE/CONTRIBUTIONS:
Founder, UX Research, Product Design and Frontend Engineering

ABOUT PISHURE:
Pishure curates the best completely free Nigerian stock photos & videos to empower creators; designers, content creators, etc., to tell true Nigerian stories in their products, ads, publication, etc.

ABOUT BAVATARS:
Bavatars is a free crowd-sourced avatar gallery of Black people to use in personal or commercial design projects or live apps. You can use Bavatars via a Figma Plugin or via our APIs. Bavatars Figma plugin has over 3,000 installs.

GITHUB REPOs:
https://github.com/Pishure/Bavatars
https://github.com/Pishure/pishure-app

USER RESEARCH DOCUMENTATION: C.N Project Portfolio

FIGMA PLUGIN LINK:
https://www.figma.com/community/plugin/999661511334406897/Bavatars

PRODUCT HUNT:
https://www.producthunt.com/posts/bavatars-by-pishure

PROJECT NAME: COSEC API Console
PRODUCT DESIGN:
https://www.figma.com/file/p2ihfwwPhU74gilJAFhYs3/COSEC-API-Console?node-id=528%3A0

MY ROLE/CONTRIBUTIONS:
UX Research, Product Design and Frontend Engineering

RESEARCH DOCUMENTATION:
http://charlesnjoku.com/digital-stock-trading-platform.html

COMPANY NAME: Spirē Technologies, Inc
FOUNDED: April 2021
INCORPORATION: C Corp, Delaware, USA
WEBSITE: www.getspire.io
PRODUCT DEMO: https://www.loom.com/share/f07095f282dd4d3dbe5c68506eb17e07
PITCH DECK:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1HhUBdaz-8UBnUox3pBIPUU9nkObN5M1R/view?usp=sharing

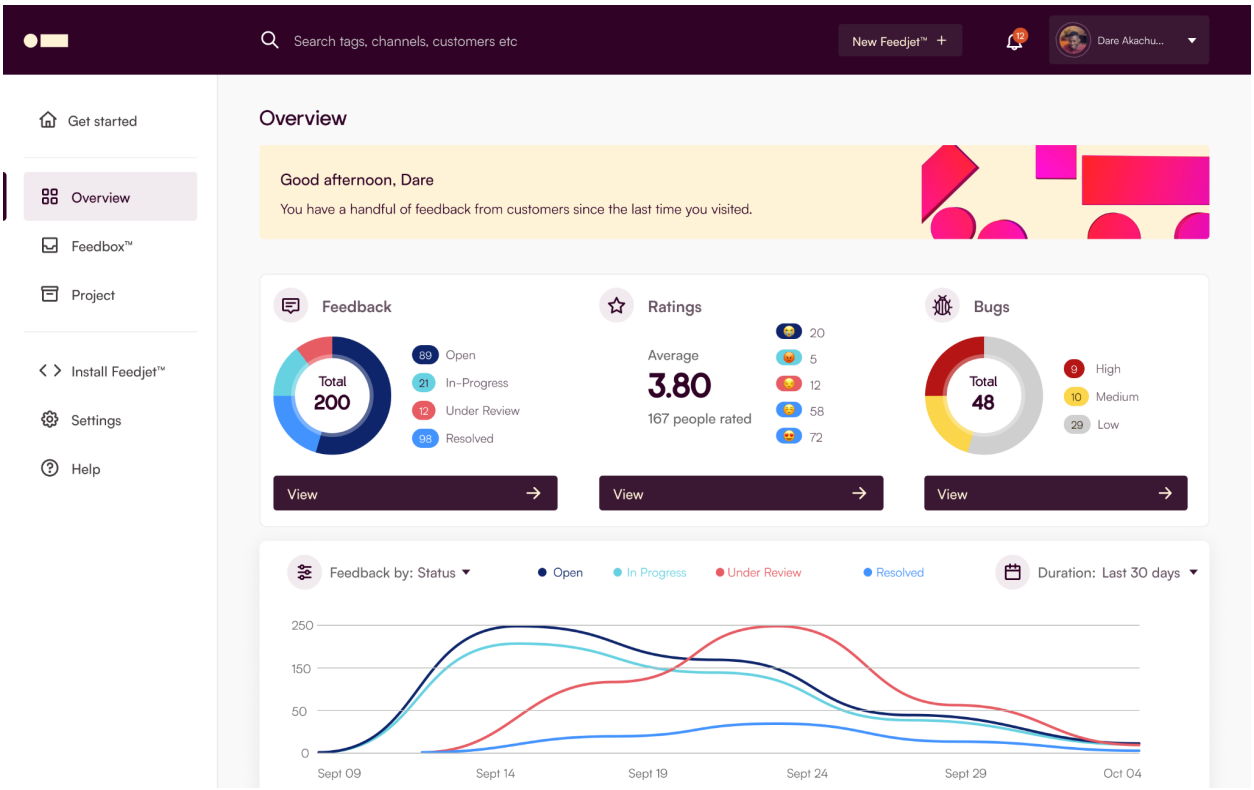
ROLE: Chief Product Officer & CEO
RAISED: $100,000 from Family & Friends
CAP TABLE:
https://spireafrica.notion.site/Spire-Cap-Table-4b6add6eeaab4e2c9ef03ef4e3813140

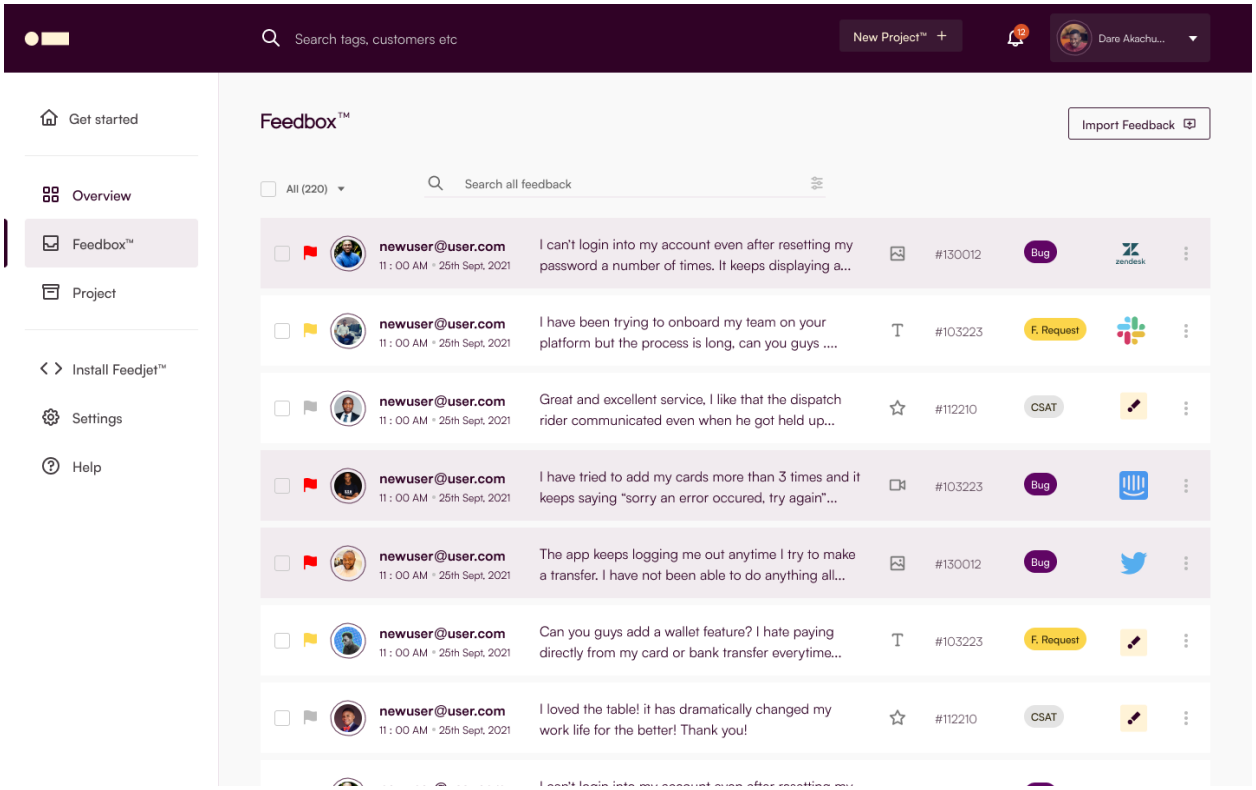
BUSINESS MODEL: B2B SaaS
STAGE: Private Beta (MVP Stage)
NO. OF CUSTOMERS IN BETA: 216

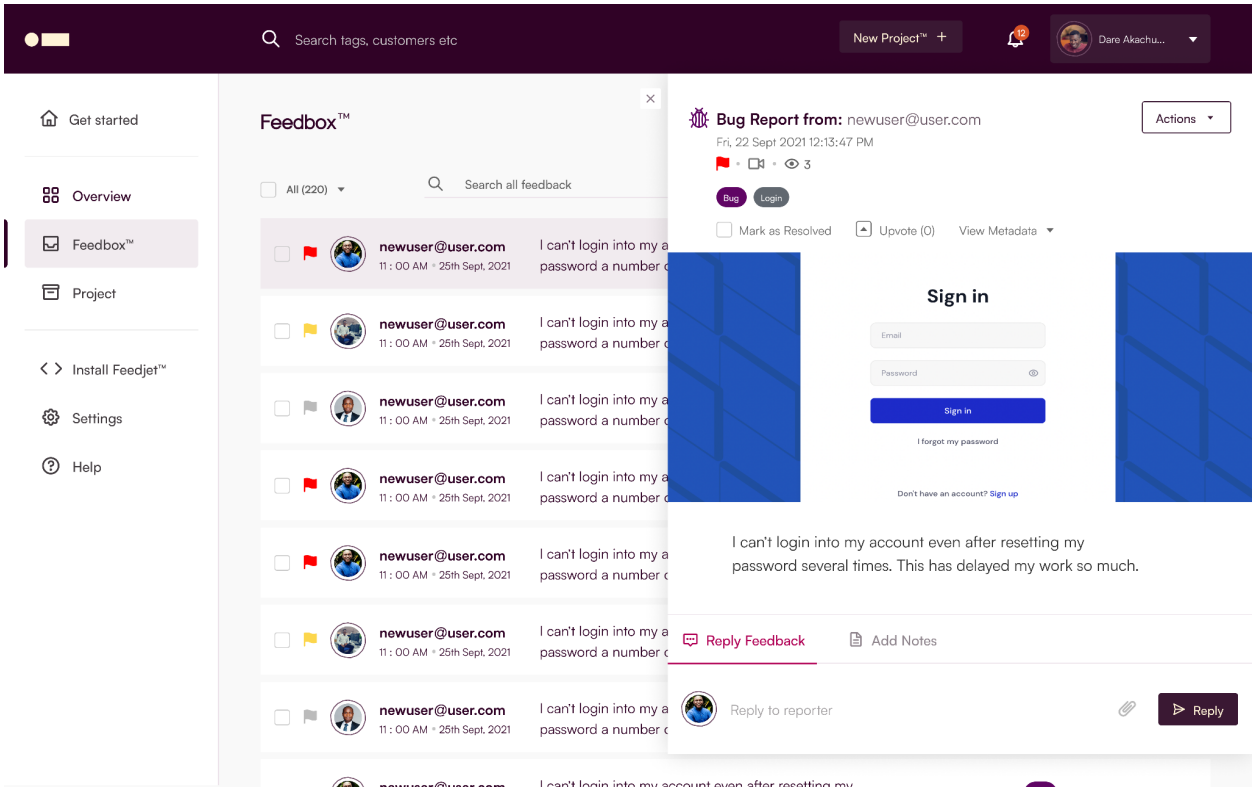
ABOUT PRODUCT:
Spirē is a suite of connected products that combine surveys, customer interviews, user research, product testing, and feedback analytics to help businesses understand who is using their product or service, why & how are they using it as well as to help them discover better ways to deliver better products and customer experience and grow their business.

NEWS FEATURES:
https://www.benjamindada.com/early-stage-african-startups-to-watch-out-for-in-2022/

PRODUCT SCREENSHOTS




Search tags, customers etc
New Project™ +
Dare Akachu...
Get started
Overview
Feedbox™
Project
Install Feedjet™
Settings
Help
Feedbox™
Import Feedback
All (220)
Search all feedback
newuser@user.com
11 : 00 AM • 25th Sept, 2021
I can't login into my account even after resetting my password a number of times. It keeps displaying a...
#130012
Bug
I have been trying to onboard my team on your platform but the process is long, can you guys ....
#103223
F. Request
Great and excellent service, I like that the dispatch rider communicated even when he got held up...
#112210
CSAT
I have tried to add my cards more than 3 times and it keeps saying "sorry an error occured, try again"...
#103223
Bug
The app keeps logging me out anytime I try to make a transfer. I have not been able to do anything all...
#130012
Bug
Can you guys add a wallet feature? I hate paying directly from my card or bank transfer everytime...
#103223
F. Request
I loved the table! it has dramatically changed my work life for the better! Thank you!
#112210
CSAT


Search tags, customers etc
New Project™ +
Dare Akachu...
Get started
Overview
Feedbox™
Project
Install Feedjet™
Settings
Help
Feedbox™
All (220)
Search all feedback
Bug Report from: newuser@user.com
Fri, 22 Sept 2021 12:13:47 PM
Actions
Bug
Login
Mark as Resolved
Upvote (0)
View Metadata
Sign in
Email
Password
Sign in
I forgot my password
Don't have an account? Sign up
I can't login into my account even after resetting my password several times. This has delayed my work so much.
Reply Feedback
Add Notes
Reply to reporter
Reply

Emmanuel Ezenwere
CEO, Arone Technologies.
(+234)9067710551
emmaezenwere@gmail.com

2nd April 2022

Tech Nation
20-22 Wenlock Road
London
N1 7GU

Dear Sir/Madam,

LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION FOR CHARLES NJOKU

My name is Emmanuel Ezenwere and I am the founder and CEO of Arone Technologies. Arone is a hardware manufacturing startup focused on solving critical challenges in Nigeria and Africa.

I met Charles in 2017 at the University of Nigeria, Nsukka where we both attended college at the time and by 2018 he joined Arone as a founding team member and was responsible for our product as well as brand design.

During his time at Arone, Charles conceptualized Arone's brand identity and communication materials and created video animations. He also led the web design and building of www.aronedelivery.com and our video-analytics web app interface for QView. His contributions were very instrumental to some of our successes. I have attached some pictures after my letter to show this. With his help, Arone won grants to the tune of $50k, won an award from NITDA that included a sponsorship to GITEX2018 in Dubai. We also won the SLUSH GIA Regional finals and had the rare opportunity to meet with Nigeria's President and top Government officials in 2019.

Having Charles on my team was very rewarding. Charles is highly skilled, disciplined and most importantly very responsible. Charles is able to come up with unique ideas for constant improvements and execute requiring very little supervision.

Today, I and Charles are both customers of each other's businesses. Arone Energies use Spire's product to collect feedback from our customers and Charles uses Arone's inverters as an alternative power supply in his home. I have experienced first-hand the value of what Spire means for growing businesses and I can attest it would be an invaluable product both in Nigeria and globally.

I am very certain that going to the UK will provide Charles and his startup with an enabling environment as well as resources in terms of capital and the market for him to succeed. The UK technology sector will also be gaining from his wealth of experience as well as the direct economic benefits when his startup grows and succeed.

I highly recommend Charles, if you have any questions please contact me.

Regards,



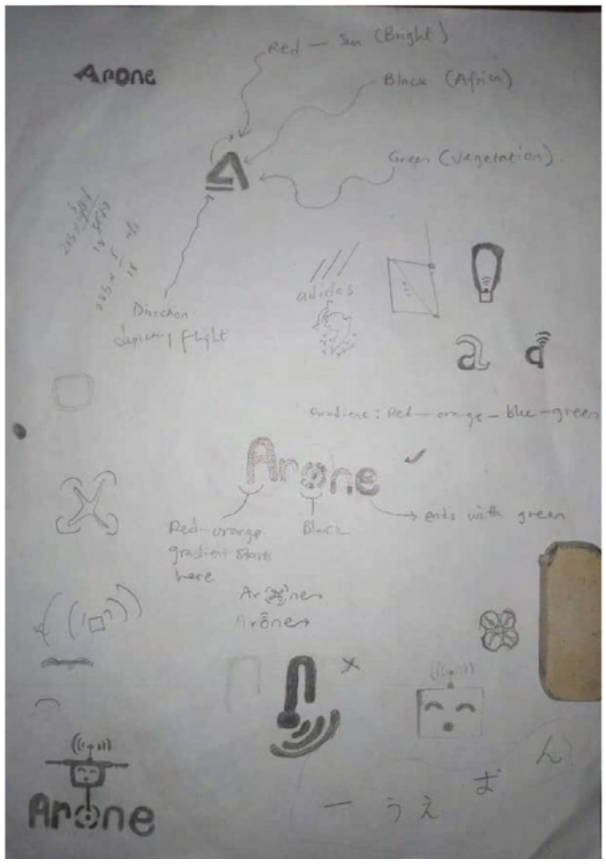
Emmanuel Ezenwere
Founder & CEO, Arone

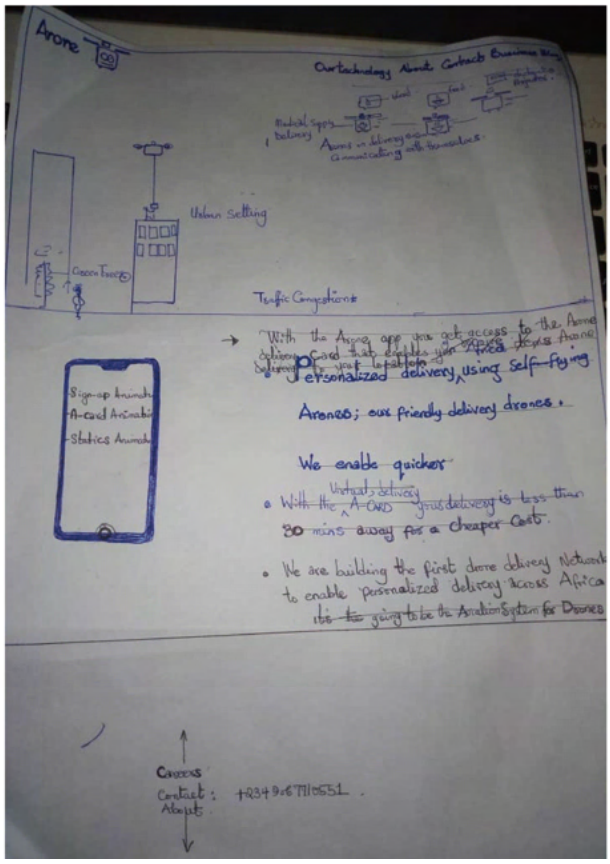


Our very first Drone Prototype



One of the earliest designs we used





Earliest iteration of Arone's logo, website and app.





Pitching to Nigeria's President and top Government officials while Charles had to demonstrate the drone via our 3D model because we couldn't fly it for security reasons.



At the signing of our MOU with Nigeria's Ministry of Defense as its Technical Partners for its UAV Program